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Identifier system not favoured

(New Zealand Press Association)

PALMERSTON NORTH, August 20.

There are no grounds at present for the establishing of a national personal-identifier system, members of the Computer Society concluded at their conference on Saturday.

In seconding a successful motion opposing the national use of identifiers, Mr R. Middleton said that before such a system could be endorsed it would require justification and acceptance.

"It was suggested that justification would require a significant increase in convenience for the public, as well as more effective administration for Government and private organisations, and the investigations in which it was involved did not show that this was so," he said.

"Acceptance by the community will, in the case of a unique identification system, require evident protection for the individual from exploitation of the system to his disadvantage."

Time and time again during interviews, concern had been expressed that the organisations most likely to use an identifier system—Government agencies and similar large organisations — were those that people most feared could abuse data which could be readily interchanged.

"The motion will allow the public of New Zealand to recognise that the Computer Society is concerned about safeguarding the handling of

Identifier system not favoured

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safeguarding the handling of personal information for the individual, and will take an active role in ensuring that computer technology brings the social benefits it can offer, and does not become a threat to the New Zealand way of life," he said.